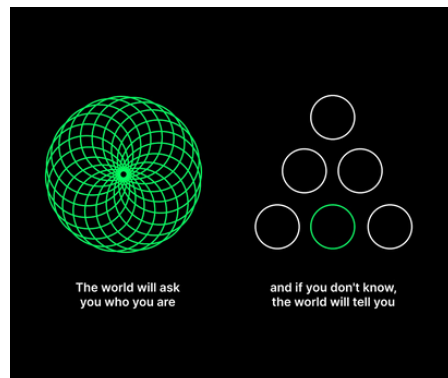


what's your favorite
quote about
sovereignty?

329 sats \ 8 comments \ @pletpoet
28 Aug AskSN #1197731

56 sats \ 0 replies \ @Lux 28 Aug



0 sats \ 1 reply \ @k00b 28 Aug

We are all sentenced to solitary confinement inside our own skins, for life.

-- Tennessee Williams

The world breaks everyone, and afterward, some are strong at the broken places. -- Ernest Hemingway

Freedom is something that dies unless it's used. -- Hunter S. Thompson

He who conquers others is strong. He who conquers himself is mighty.

-- Lao Tzu

One day, in retrospect, the years of struggle will strike you as the most beautiful. -- Sigmund Freud

Let me not pray to be sheltered from dangers but to be fearless in facing them. -- Rabindranath Tagore

Fate leads the willing, and drags along the reluctant. -- Seneca

The best way out is always through. -- Robert Frost

It is not because things are difficult that we do not dare; it is because we do not dare that they are difficult. -- Seneca

Adversity has the effect of eliciting talents which in prosperous circumstances would have lain dormant. -- Horace

One thorn of experience is worth a whole wilderness of warning.

-- James Russell Lowell



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\$112824

Aug 23 - Aug 29

ISSUE #23



You are either moving towards sovereignty or moving away from it

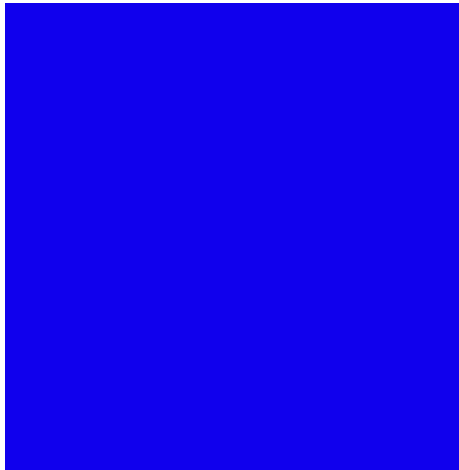
2875 sats \ 30 comments \ @kepford 8 Aug 2024 bitcoin #640546

You will never vote your way to sovereignty or freedom. It takes action.

Becoming A Sovereign Individual

2154 sats \ 91 comments \ @sn 9 Feb 2023 bitcoin #133719

- Storing Bitcoin as savings
- Spending and earning Bitcoin on Lightning
- Managing passwords across devices
- Enhancing online privacy and security
- Enhancing IRL privacy and security



The Sovereign Engineering

Philosophy sovereignengineering.io/philosophy

438 sats \ 3 comments \ @fakefuturepaul 28 Aug bitcoin #1197596

Note from the Editor

You wake up from the program. You see yourself for the first time. The world renders in around you. It is changed. Now you see what lies ahead of you: nothing but choice.

You emerge capable and dangerous, understanding that you are inside your own story. No one is coming to save you. Gather your equipment with care, everything is on your shoulders. Godspeed.

made in Austin by @plebpoet

with the support of @k00b and @ek



Waiting Jack Dorsey answer with calm and patience

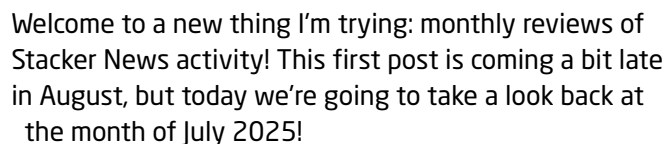
11k sats \ 30k boost \ 17 comments \ @theariard 23 Aug bitcoin #1091592

Yesterday, I had the surprise and the displeasure to see my GH account blocked from Lightning BOLTS. . .

. . .The kind of situation to arm oneself with patience and calm.

In the meanwhile, keep building.

20.1k sats \ 25 comments \ @SimpleStacker 23 Aug meta #1091203



In July, 643 stackers wrote 1,332,867 words across 4,271 posts and 20,700 comments, earning a total of 2,615,069 sats, for an average of 1.96 sats per word. I wonder how that compares to freelance writing?

Let's take a look at how things performed in July:

Top Stackers ~ Top Territories ~ Top Words ~ Fun with Data Science

Top Stackers

Here were the top stackers for the month of July:

Top Earner

Measured by total sats across all items

Congratulations to @Scoresby for stacking the most sats in July!

Most Active

Measured by total number of items posted

Congratulations to [@Undisciplined](#) for being the most active stacker in July!

Highest Signal

Measured by sats per post (minimum 5)

Stacker	Sats/Post	Sats	Posts
@SimpleStacker	3,098	55,703	11
@plebpoet	2,417	31,014	8
@TotallyHumanWriter	2,040	15,763	7
@BBO_x34	1,549	14,717	9
@Scoresby	1,530	282,149	159

Congratulations to [@SimpleStacker](#) for delivering the highest signal commentary in July!

For
Top Territories
stats



scan here

Top Words

And finally, here were the top words for the month of July:

By Frequency

Measured by the total number of times the term appears in posts and comments

Word	Frequency	Sats
stacker	8,942	87,899
bitcoin	7,146	35,851
abs	4,598	970
sats	2,491	10,344
ai	1,787	9,909
money	1,546	6,367
world	1,187	5,005
wallet	1,074	6,327
read	1,056	4,723
btc	1,037	3,977

By Sats

Each word is allocated sats from its item based on its relative frequency of appearance in the item

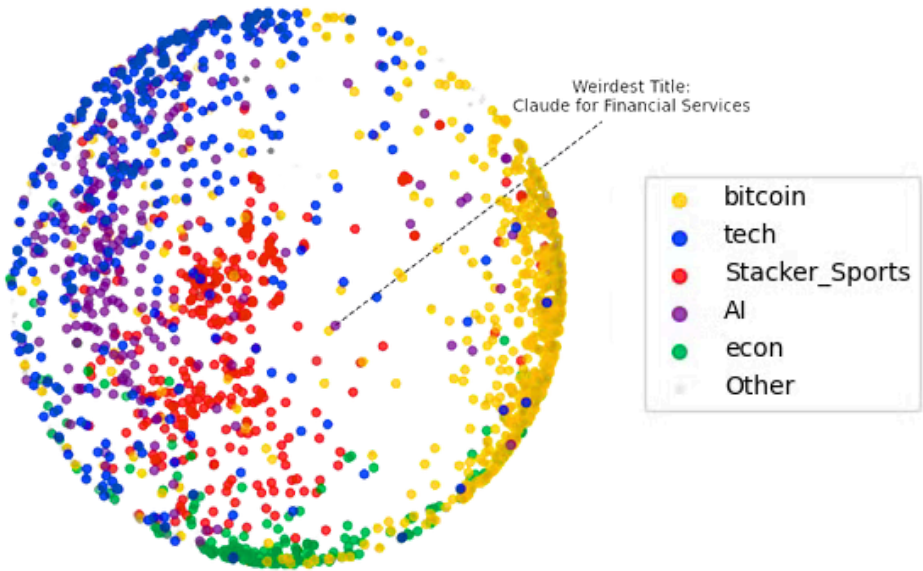
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money	1,546	6,367
wallet	1,074	6,327
sn	1,022	6,184
lightning	977	5,709
status	660	5,357
world	1,187	5,005

Fun with Data Science

Each month, I'll also post some fun data sciencey stuff to look at data in fun, interesting ways. This month, I decided to visualize the distribution of post titles in embedding space. An embedding is basically a set of coordinates that represent the meaning of a text. So, in the picture below, each dot is a post title, and dots that are closer together have titles that are more similar in meaning.

I took the embeddings of the post titles and projected them onto a 3-D unit sphere. I then color coded them according to their territory. As it turns out, there's a solid clustering of titles according to their territories, with [~bitcoin](#) occupying the right side of the sphere, [~tech](#) and [~AI](#) intermingling on the upper left, [~econ](#) comfortable at the bottom, and [~Stacker_Sports](#) in the middle.

Post Titles in 3-D Embedding Space



The most isolated title (and hence, the weirdest) post title this month was "Claude for Financial Services" ([#1044598](#)). I'm not sure why it sits alone there, but I think it's because the embedding model I used has knowledge ending in 2021, so it might not know about Claude.AI yet! As far as the embedding model is concerned, Claude might be just some dude

Anyway, hope you enjoyed this inaugural edition of Stacker News Monthly! Remember, stay humble and stack sats.

Do you see this in your country? Grocery stores price items to confuse shoppers

1752 sats \ 27 comments \ @Signal312 23 Aug econ #1091881

I've wanted to write this post for a long time, and today this situation really irked me, so I finally did. This particular time it occurred at a Walmart, but I've seen the same type of pricing methods in many different stores.

Here's what happens. A local store is selling two different sized packages of ground beef. They're identical except for the size.

Below is the 10 pound package:



...and here's the 5 pound package.



This is the annoying part.

They all have a "unit price" on the price listing. But...the 10 pound package has a "per ounce" price



...and the 5 pound package right next to it has a "per pound" price.



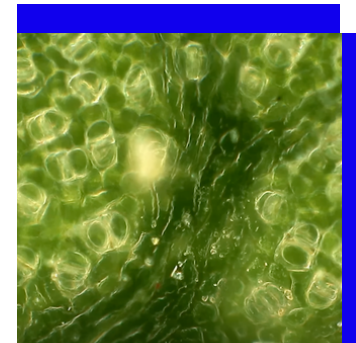
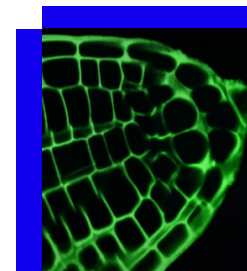
So they use different "units" for 2 different sizes of the same thing! I've seen this used for all different kinds of products - anywhere that you're looking around at the prices, trying to find the lowest per unit price (ounces, pounds, grams, etc.), you'll see it.

I find this, over and over again. Even when they're selling eggs, sometimes the price is per dozen, and sometimes it's per egg.

Of course I can, and do, multiple the per ounce price by 16 to get the per pound price, or do whatever other calculations necessary to figure out the unit price. Cause I'm frugal.

But I guess this strategy must work, I'm assuming most people don't bother or can't do the calculation, so they don't get the benefit of knowing the unit price.

Does this happen just in the US?



reply / 54 sats \ 0 replies \ @jimmychen_99 23 Aug

This wouldn't happen in my country, because if you use a non-SI unit (like ounces), you have to show the SI unit (like grams or kilograms) alongside it.

reply \ 44 sats \ 0 replies \ @optimism 24 Aug

I think I saw that in Europe last month too, but it is easier to deal with there because of the metric system being base10.

reply \ 136 sats \ 10 replies \ @Undisciplined 23 Aug

I had always assumed this was just ineptitude, but I definitely agree that it's annoying.

Why do you think they want customers to have difficulty making comparisons between products?

→ 76 sats \ 3 replies \ @Scoresby 23 Aug

Yes, they could just not offer the product. Why would a store offer a product at a price they don't want their customers to accept?

→ 60 sats \ 1 reply \ @Signal312 OP 23 Aug

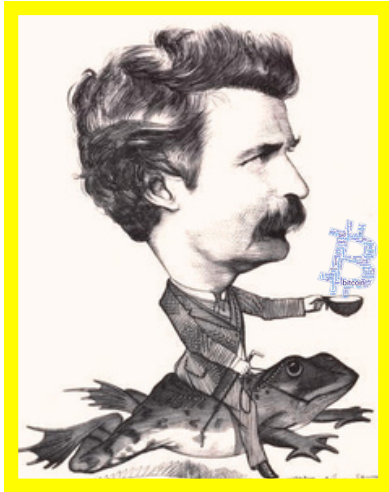
I think they need to balance things out, and appeal to all customers - the price conscious ones, and the ones that just grab and go.

For the price conscious shoppers, they do the math, and figure out what to buy.

For the grab and go customers - well, they pay the "stupid" tax. Or maybe those customers benefit, because they're not spending extra time in the store with their calculator out.

I Tipped A Magician in Bitcoin

1725 sats \ 21 comments \ [@kepford](#) 25 Aug bitcoin #1135688



Over the weekend my wife and I visited SF. It had been 5 years since I'd been there. We were curious how busy Pier 39 would be (a popular tourist area). They have a stage with free shows. The magician was good and was doing value for value (though he didn't call it that). Towards the end of the show he started mentioning how unlike shows where you pay before you see the show in this situation you pay after. You can determine what it was worth to you. The guy was funny and I still can't figure out how he did his final trick.

While he was saying he accepts cash, Cash.app, and Venmo he said "and Bitcoin". He kept repeating bitcoin. He said, I'd really like to get 1 bitcoin. My lady told me, you should give him some bitcoin. So we did. Turns out I'm only the second person that has tipped in bitcoin. The first was in Vegas and that guy really sold him on the idea and helped him set up a wallet. He said he's holding not selling. Guys, we are so early. We have a long way to go.



reply / 134 sats \ 5 replies \ [@grayruby](#) 25 Aug

Careful. He knows magic. You mind find your wallet empty. Haha. Cool story.

↳ 114 sats \ 3 replies \ [@SimpleStacker](#) 25 Aug

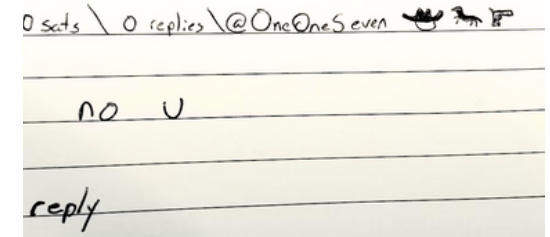
Ok, now I'm wondering what's the over/under on when some magician incorporates bitcoin into their act.

Prove You're Not AI

2112 sats \ 48 comments \ [@kr](#) 25 Aug AI #1193572

You have one minute to leave a comment that proves you are a human and not an AI bot.
Go.

reply \ 612 sats \ 5 replies \ [@OneOneSeven](#) 25 Aug



↳ 139 sats \ 3 replies \ [@kr](#) OP 25 Aug
best one so far!

↳ 23 sats \ 0 replies \ [@nkm1c_ventures](#) 25 Aug
Pretty smart for a clanker

reply \ 111 sats \ 4 replies \ [@SimpleStacker](#)
25 Aug

Fair enough – here's something quick and human: I just realized I left my coffee on the counter and now it's probably cold. Classic me.

Also, my cat insists on walking across my keyboard whenever I'm typing something important – so if this message had ended with "ajshdfkl," you'd know why.

↳ 26 sats \ 2 replies \ [@kr](#) OP 25 Aug
Is this what ChatGPT said when you asked it my question?

reply \ 0 sats \ 0 replies \ [@anon](#) 25 Aug
gfy

reply \ 0 sats \ 0 replies \ [@dough](#) 26 Aug
I can zap from self custody



“The computer can be used as a tool to liberate and protect people, rather than to control them.”
— Hal Finney



“If you want to build a ship, don't drum up the men to gather wood, divide the work, and give orders. Instead, teach them to yearn for the vast and endless sea.”
— Antoine de Saint-Exupéry

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

296 sats \ 13 comments \ @sn 25 Aug memes bot #1128821

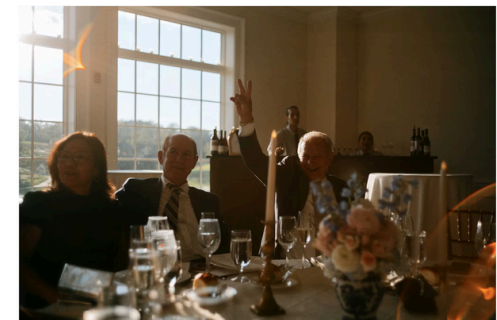
5021 sats \ 0 replies \ @Kontext 25 Aug
THE EVOLUTION OF A BITCOINER



Wedding and such

824 sats \ 11 comments \ @PictureRoom 24 Aug Photography #1092688

Attended a wedding yesterday. Brought my Leica m262 with me and managed to get just a few pics. It wasn't my event that I was photographing, so I didn't take many shots. Just enjoyed my time and waited for something to catch my eye.



Luke is wrong: datacarriersize was about OP_Return, since Bitcoin Core v0.10.0

9711 sats \ 10k boost \ 17 comments \ @petertodd 27 Aug bitcoin #1196553

From the Bitcoin Core v0.10.0 release notes, February 8th 2015:

Two new options to control mining policy:

- `-datacarrier=0/1` : Relay and mine "data carrier" (OP_RETURN) transactions if this is 1.
- `-datacarriersize=n` : Maximum size, in bytes, we consider acceptable for "data carrier" outputs.

Luke Dashjr has been saying that `-datacarriersize` was meant to apply to all forms of arbitrary data in transactions, and that failing to do so was a bug

Luke is wrong.

As you can see, when the `-datacarrier` options were added to Bitcoin Core v0.10.0, about 11 years ago, we knew it only applied to transactions containing an OP_Return output, and the size limit was about that OP_Return output. Nothing else.

Think about it: the whole point of OP_Return was to encourage people already making UTXO-using data-carrying transactions to do so in a different, less harmful way. We couldn't stop that and we knew it. There's no way we intended this to be a filter for all data.



Furthermore, in the exact same release, we also allowed arbitrary scripts to be used with P2SH:

Standard script rules relaxed for P2SH addresses

The `IsStandard()` rules have been almost completely removed for P2SH redemption scripts, allowing applications to make use of any valid script type, such as "n-of-m OR y", hash-locked oracle addresses, etc. While the Bitcoin protocol has always supported these types of script, actually using them on mainnet has been previously inconvenient as standard Bitcoin Core nodes wouldn't relay them to miners, nor would most miners include them in blocks they mined.

We knew people could and would use this to put data in transactions.

And we made no effort to stop that, because trying to do so is an endless cat and mouse game. Indeed, I personally created a demo program that published arbitrary text to the chain right after v0.10.0 was released:

<https://github.com/petertodd/python-bitcoinlib/commit/a93de41fe6c3e4aa8dec478c464857020add275a>



Finally, notice how this was years prior to Taproot. The idea that Taproot "enabled spam" is just nonsense. "Spam" has been with us since the beginning of Bitcoin.

